

Major contributors to this report



Debasish Paul Choudhury
President, SEMI India



Deepak Zade
Senior vice president (energy and carbon services), MITCON Consultancy & Engineering Services



K. Subramanya
Chief executive officer
Tata BP Solar



S.R.C. Sathyanarayan
Head-PV power plants, TÜV Rheinland (I)

nection with the transmission network of the state transmission utility, central transmission utility or any other transmission utility at a voltage level of 33 kV or above. The project developer should indicate to the transmission licensee the location (*tehsil*, village and district, as applicable) of the proposed project. In this regard, he needs to submit a letter from the transmission utility along with RIS confirming technical feasibility of the connectivity of the plant to the substation.

The responsibility of getting connectivity and open access to the transmission system owned by the transmission utility, as may be required, lies with the project developer. The transmission of power up to the point of interconnection where the metering is done is the responsibility of the solar power developer at his own cost. Interconnection with the Discom network may be accepted in exceptional cases where the Discom is the ultimate buyer of the entire quantity of power from that pro-

ject; and NVVN has signed power sale agreement with that Discom and the Discom agrees to an agreed interconnection point and at an agreed voltage. This arrangement is subject to the arrangement of energy accounting with the state load dispatch centre.

The arrangement of connectivity can be made by the solar power developer through a dedicated transmission line which he may construct himself or get constructed by the state transmission utility, Discom or any other agency. The entire cost of transmission including the cost of construction of line, wheeling charges, losses, etc from the project up to the interconnection point are to be borne by the project developer and not reimbursed by NVVN or met by the state transmission utility or Discom. This connectivity can also be achieved through a shared line with any agency or any existing line of Discom or state transmission utility, provided the energy accounts are bifurcated and clearly demarcated for the power generated at the solar project and are issued by the state transmission utility or state load dispatch centre concerned.

The project developer may, however, shift the interconnection point closer to his project if 33kV substation comes closer to the project during the tenure of the PPA, provided that: (a) the interconnection is maintained at 33 kV or above and energy at the solar project is clearly demarcated for the power generated at the solar project and

(b) energy accounts are issued by the state transmission utility or state load dispatch centre concerned. The costs associated with this arrangement, including the wheeling charges and losses up to the interconnect point, are also to be borne by the project developer.

Domestic content. One of the important objectives of the National Solar Mission is to promote domestic manufacturing. In view of this, the developers are expected to procure their project components from domestic manufacturers as much as possible. However, in the case of solar PV projects selected in the first batch during FY 2010-11, it was mandatory for projects based on crystalline silicon technology to use only the modules manufactured in India.

For solar PV projects to be selected in the second batch during FY 2011-12 too, it will be mandatory for all the projects to use cells and modules manufactured in India. PV modules made from thin-film technologies or concentrator PV cells may be sourced from any country, provided the technical qualification criterion is fully met.

Key to success

Effective planning, management and execution are the keys to success. Getting the project financed at a reasonable rate of 3-4 per cent is another step towards the project's success. ●

The author is an executive editor at EYF

Requirements in a nutshell

1. Sound financial status of the investor
2. Land suited for solar application (4 to 5 acres per MW)
3. Power purchase agreement (PPA) with the local/state electrical authority
4. Selection of technically proven and commercially viable technologies
5. Compliance with all formalities
6. Close supervision of project implementation and maintenance